

The Great Political Realignment: Left & Right At The Crossroads

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America's two major political parties are beginning to come apart--but not in the same way.

On the right, prominent America First figures are accusing President Donald Trump of betraying the movement he built. Some are now discussing a new political coalition, a third party and even a possible Tucker Carlson presidential campaign in 2028.

On the left, democratic socialists are not preparing to abandon the Democratic Party. They are methodically moving through its primaries, defeating establishment candidates and attempting to capture the party from within.

One rebellion may split its party. The other may take over its party.

Together, they represent something much larger than another season of partisan infighting. The political order that governed America for decades is beginning to fracture--and what replaces it could radically change the country's relationship with government, capitalism, foreign policy and Israel.

The Revolt Against Trump

The latest rupture on the right became visible at Tucker Carlson's cabin in Maine, where Carlson appeared with Marjorie Taylor Greene, Thomas Massie and former National Counterterrorism Center director Joe Kent.

Greene declared that Trump had betrayed supporters who believed his promise to avoid new foreign wars. Carlson responded that MAGA itself had been betrayed and that it was time for "a new path forward."

Kent later revealed that members of the group had urged Carlson to run for president in 2028, although Carlson has repeatedly said he does not intend to seek office. Kent also said the coalition was examining what would be required to place a third-party candidate on ballots across the country.

Whether Carlson ever runs is almost secondary. The important development is that influential voices once united behind Trump are now openly questioning whether Trump still represents America First.

The dispute is exposing a weakness that was always present inside MAGA. Was it a movement built around enduring principles--or a movement built around loyalty to one man?

Millions of conservatives supported Trump because he challenged open borders, globalism, political correctness and the permanent Washington establishment. But many also believed he would avoid unnecessary wars, confront government secrecy and reduce the influence of foreign interests.

When supporters believe those promises have been broken, are they betraying Trump by objecting--or is Trump betraying the movement by changing direction?

That argument may define the Republican future.

The Socialist March Through The Democratic Party

The Democratic revolt is following a very different strategy.

The Democratic Socialists of America generally does not run candidates as part of a competing national party. Its candidates enter Democratic primaries, use the Democratic ballot line and challenge the party's established officeholders.

DSA openly acknowledges this approach. The organization argues that third parties face enormous ballot-access barriers and risk splitting the vote. Its preferred method is to place socialist candidates before Democratic primary voters while supporting them with a permanent political organization capable of organizing volunteers and holding elected officials accountable.

That strategy is producing results.

DSA says it has more than 100,000 members. By early July, the organization and its local chapters had endorsed 150 candidates in 2026, recording 38 victories. DSA-backed candidates have won congressional primaries, mayoral contests and state and local races.

The movement received another significant boost when progressive Abdul El-Sayed defeated establishment-backed Representative Haley Stevens in Michigan's Democratic Senate primary. El-Sayed's victory demonstrated that the insurgent left may be able to win beyond deeply Democratic urban districts and compete in one of America's most important swing states.

The socialist left is not asking permission to establish a separate party. It is attempting to inherit the Democratic Party itself.

Two Strategies, The Same Target

The MAGA dissidents and democratic socialists are not ideological allies. Their visions for America are profoundly different.

But they share a target: the political establishment.

Both movements accuse party leaders of serving donors, corporations, lobbyists and entrenched institutions instead of ordinary Americans. Both attract voters who believe the traditional parties make promises during elections and return to business as usual afterward.

Their methods, however, could not be more different.

The America First rebels are threatening to walk away from the Republican Party and build something new. The socialist left is using the Democratic Party's infrastructure to remove its existing leadership.

The Republican rebels could destroy their influence by leaving. The socialists could transform their party by staying.

These Movements Are Not Morally Equivalent

Conservatives should not mistake this comparison for equivalence.

Some grievances driving the America First rebellion are legitimate. Christians should never give unquestioning loyalty to a politician, even one who accomplished important things. Opposition to reckless military intervention, government corruption and broken campaign promises is not inherently disloyal.

But legitimate concerns can also drift into dangerous territory--especially when opposition to foreign wars becomes hostility toward Israel or when disappointment with one leader turns into scorched-earth warfare against everyone who disagrees.

The socialist program is far more comprehensive and radical. DSA advocates government control of major industries and openly seeks to replace capitalism. Its program includes universal rent control, sharply higher taxes, ending immigration detention and deportation, granting amnesty regardless of immigration status and radically restructuring American political institutions.

Socialism promises security and equality but concentrates extraordinary power in the state. History repeatedly demonstrates that governments empowered to provide everything eventually claim the authority to control everything.

Israel In The Crossfire

For Christians who understand Israel's biblical and historical significance, the most alarming convergence may be foreign policy.

The socialist left openly seeks to end all American military and economic assistance to Israel. DSA's official program endorses a Palestinian "right to return," a "right to resist" and a Palestinian state with Jerusalem as its capital.

Meanwhile, parts of the populist right increasingly portray support for Israel as another example of foreign lobbying and overseas entanglement.

The two factions arrive at this position from opposite directions. The socialist left approaches Israel through anti-capitalism, anti-colonialism and Palestinian nationalism. The populist right approaches it through noninterventionism and America First nationalism.

But Israel could suffer from the result either way.

A Reuters/Ipsos poll found that only 16 percent of Democrats supported continued military and economic assistance to Israel, while 57 percent opposed it. More than 80 percent of liberal Democrats considered reducing or eliminating that support important or essential.

For decades, Israel could depend upon strong Republican support and at least substantial Democratic support. That bipartisan foundation is now rapidly eroding.

What Happened To The Political Center?

The old Republican and Democratic establishments assumed voters would continue accepting carefully managed candidates, donor-approved policies and modest differences within a largely stable system.

That assumption is collapsing.

Many Americans no longer believe the country's institutions represent them. They are angry about inflation, housing costs, immigration, foreign wars, cultural radicalism and a government that appears increasingly distant from ordinary life.

But political anger does not automatically produce wisdom.

A third-party America First campaign could divide conservative voters and hand power to the very forces it claims to oppose. A socialist capture of the Democratic Party could move one of America's major parties toward policies that would dramatically expand government power, undermine economic freedom and abandon Israel.

Christians should therefore resist the temptation to search for another political messiah.

Trump is not the foundation of conservatism. Tucker Carlson is not the savior of America First. Nor will socialism redeem a nation by redistributing its wealth and empowering its government.

Political leaders must be judged by truth and principle--not the other way around.

America is entering a great political realignment. The Republican Party may split over what America First means after Trump. The Democratic Party may be transformed by socialists who have learned that capturing an existing institution is easier than building a new one.

The old order is breaking. The greater question is whether what rises in its place will restore constitutional government and moral clarity--or accelerate America's descent into division, radicalism and national decline.

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